

Types of Paragraph Writing



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Descriptive Paragraphs

Purpose: To vividly describe a person, place, object, or event using sensory details to create a clear mental image for the reader.

Example: A descriptive paragraph about a beach might include descriptions of the warm sun, the sound of waves crashing, the feel of sand between toes, and the smell of salt in the air.

Narrative Paragraphs

Purpose: To tell a story or recount a sequence of events in chronological order, often with a clear beginning, middle, and end.

Example: A narrative paragraph might describe a memorable vacation, a childhood experience, or an exciting adventure, focusing on storytelling elements like plot, characters, and setting.

Expository Paragraphs

Purpose: To explain or inform the reader about a specific topic, concept, or idea, providing factual information, analysis, or evidence to support the main point.

Example: An expository paragraph about climate change might discuss its causes, effects, and potential solutions, presenting scientific data and expert opinions to inform the reader.

Persuasive Paragraphs

Purpose: To convince the reader to adopt a particular viewpoint, take a specific action, or change their beliefs or behavior by presenting arguments, evidence, and reasoning.

Example: A persuasive paragraph might argue for the importance of recycling, urging readers to reduce waste and protect the environment by recycling materials whenever possible.

A basic Paragraph - 4 key parts

1	Topic sentence – key topic in this paragraph.
2	Development – the main idea / topic discussed in more detail.
3	Example – support / evidence / data / statistics that show your development is valid / credible.
4	Summary – overall main point summarised / evaluated.

Paragraph structure

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) can generate a positive reputation for a company leading to possibly more sales and growth. According to Jones et al (2019), a corporation that invests in the environmental and ethical approaches of CSR will demonstrate to the public and the media that they are a responsible company. Watson (2018) provides evidence that this improves consumer sales as customers tend to support ethical green business practice thus improving profitability and encouraging growth. For example, a yoghurt company called Yeo Valley has been investing in making its products organic, creating fully recyclable packaging and reducing its CO2 output. As a result, profits have doubled within the last two years providing the company with a range of opportunities to expand (Peterson, 2019). Overall, the evidence seems to suggest that investing in CSR can improve brand image and productivity.

Descriptive Paragraph (This excerpt is taken from *The Great Gatsby* by F. Scott Fitzgerald.)

The lights grow brighter as the earth lurches away from the sun, and now the orchestra is playing yellow cocktail music, and the opera of voices pitches a key higher. Laughter is easier minute by minute, spilled with prodigality, tipped out at a cheerful word. The groups change more swiftly, swell with new arrivals, dissolve and form in the same breath; already there are wanderers, confident girls who weave here and there among the stouter and more stable, become from a sharp, joyous moment the center of a group, and then, excited with triumph, glide on through the sea-change of faces and voices and color under the constantly changing light.

Narrative Paragraph (Opening paragraph from Barack Obama's *The Audacity of Hope*)

It's been almost ten years since I first ran for political office. I was thirty-five at the time, four years out of law school, recently married, and generally impatient with life. A seat in the Illinois legislature had opened up, and several friends suggested that I run, thinking that my work as a civil rights lawyer, and contacts from my days as a community organizer, would make me a viable candidate. After discussing it with my wife, I entered the race and proceeded to do what every first-time candidate does: I talked to anyone who would listen. I went to block club meetings and church socials, beauty shops and barbershops. If two guys were standing on a corner, I would cross the street to hand them campaign literature. And everywhere I went, I'd get some version of the same two questions.

Expository Paragraph (Paragraph from Reader's Digest *Complete Do-it-yourself Manual*)

All toilet flush tanks work about the same. When the toilet is flushed, the trip handle lifts the tank ball, opening the outlet and letting water flow into the bowl. When the tank is nearly empty, the ball falls back in place over the outlet. The float falls with the water level, opening the water-supply inlet valve just as the outlet is being closed, and the tank is refilled through the filler tube. Water also flows through the bowl refill tube into the overflow pipe to replenish trap-sealing water. As the water level in the tank nears the top of the overflow pipe, the float closes the inlet valve, completing the cycle.

Persuasive Paragraph (Internet)

Immigration contributes to the overall health of the American economy. Despite recent concerns related to the costs created by illegal and some legal immigration to the United States, this country has largely benefited from the skills, talents, and ambition that immigrants bring with them. American businesses gain from a good source of affordable labor, while towns and cities are revitalized by immigrant families who strengthen communities through civic participation and the generation of new economic activity. The United States must continue to welcome new arrivals and help those who are already here; otherwise, the country will lose the advantages it has over other industrialized countries who compete against us in the global marketplace and seek to recruit from a vast pool of unskilled and skilled global workers.

THANKS.

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